

he ‘wants’ to text his crush, well, he can always use your phone. It’s his choice.

Ultimately you know your kid better than I do—so I’ll leave it to you to get your teen over the line.

And when they’re ready, I’m going to knock their socks off, so that they can become fully Barefoot.

Behold . . .

The three-step guide to getting a job with no experience

Your teen can go from zero experience to hero in three simple steps—let me show you how it works.

Step 1: The taxi rank

The first step is for you, the parent.

It’s called ‘the taxi rank’ because you are the taxi, and you get to rank (shortlist) the workplaces you’re prepared to drive your teen to and from. (Sure, your teen may want to be a jackaroo herding cattle, but if you live in inner-city Paddington they can just as easily work behind the counter at the local butcher.)

So, right now in the margins of this book, or with your phone, jot down a list of youth-friendly employers that are close by your home or the school. Think shopping malls, supermarkets, fast food joints and small businesses.

The biggest employers of young people in Australia are McDonald’s, Woolworths, KFC, Coles and small businesses. So to help you make your decision, and make this a no-brainer, I’ve dug deep and spoken to the head HR officers of the big four and a local business, and got you some job hacks you won’t find anywhere else . . .